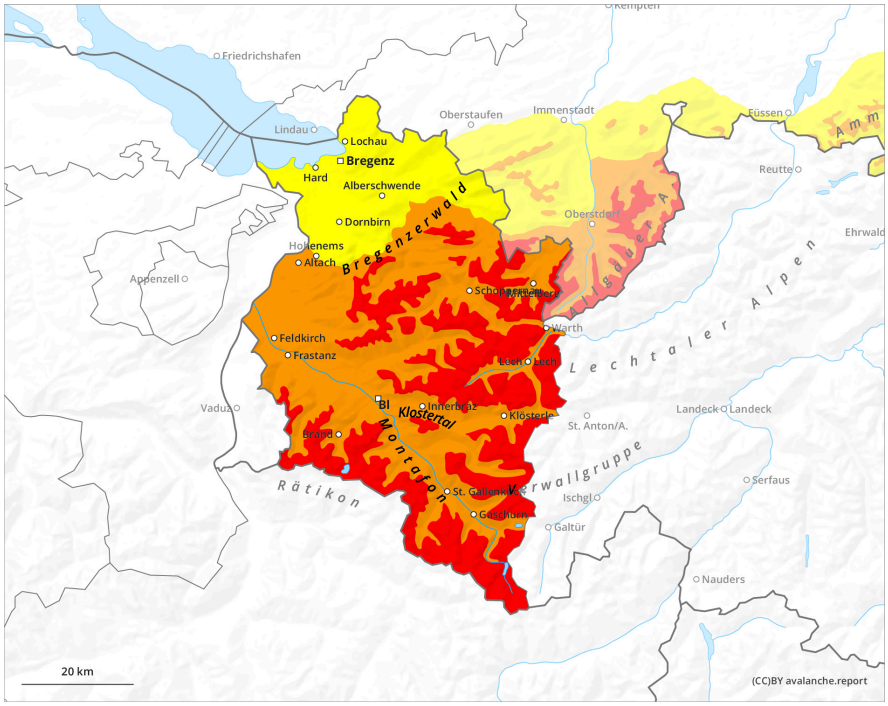
Tuesday 17 February 2026

Published 16 Feb 2026, 17:00:00
Valid from 16 Feb 2026, 17:00:00 until 17 Feb 2026, 17:00:00
Written by Andreas Pecl

Fresh snow and story winds creating critical avalanche situation



1	2	3	4	5
low	moderate	considerable	high	very high

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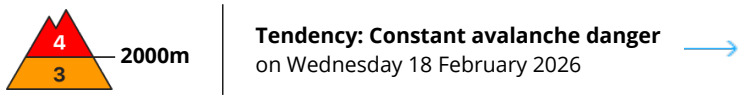
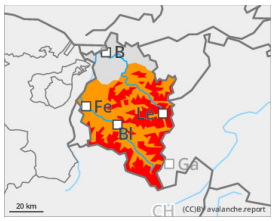
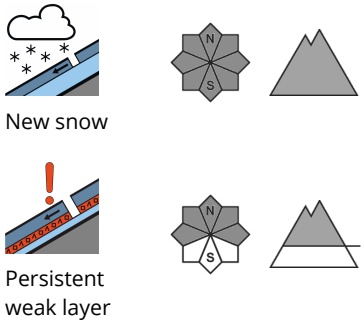
Danger Level 4 - High



Tendency: Constant avalanche danger
on Wednesday 18 February 2026





HIGH avalanche danger outside of ski runs

Intensive precipitation and storm-strength winds will lead to high avalanche danger above 2000m. Avalanches can easily be triggered by one single winter sports enthusiast in all aspecdts and then grow to to large size. Danger zones occur on steep slopes near to and distant from ridgelines, behind drops in the landscape and in wind-loaded gullies and bowls. Frequency and spread of avalanche prone locations increase with ascending altitude. Also naturally triggered avalanches can be expected. The danger is especially acute in alpine terrain where winter sports are practiced. Whumpf noises and fractures which appear when treading upon the snowpack, as well as freshly released avalanches are alarm signals. Activities in outlying terrain demand restraint. The inexperienced should not leave secured ski runs.

Snowpack

By Tuesday evening, 20-40cm of fresh snow is anticipated. Storm-strength westerly-to-northwesterly winds will transport the snow, generate fresh snowdrift accumulations. Fresh snow and drifts often lie deposited on top of graupel, in wind-protected terrain also atop surface hoar or on thin, trigger-sensitive melt-freeze layers. Also older snowdrifts and the weak snowpack will be blanketed by fresh snowfall.

Weather

From dense cloud cover, heavy snowfall is expected in the northwestern barrier cloud regions: poor visibility, gusty winds, wintery cold temperatures. Temperature at 2000m: -8 degrees; at 3000m: -15 degrees. Strong to storm-strength westerly-to-northwesterly winds at high altitudes.

Tendency

As precipitation tapers off, danger of naturally triggered avalanches will gradually diminish